

Seattle Police Department

Business Development Dossier

Industry	Law Enforcement
Revenue	\$462M
Employees	1,400
Ideal Customer Profile Score	79

ICP SCORING MODEL



ICP = Signals + Revenue + Employees + Fit (max 100)

Signals (0-35)	Top 4 signals scored; each = base(60%) + recency bonus <30d: 40% <90d: 30% <180d: 20% older: 10%
Revenue (0-25)	\$500M-\$10B sweet spot -> 70-100% of 25 pts Below \$500M -> pro-rata x 0.5 Above \$10B -> 60%
Employees (0-20)	2,000+ preferred (70-100%) 500-2K partial (50-70%) Below 500 -> pro-rata x 0.3
Fit (0-20)	High-fit types: reorg, transformation, M&A, hiring, funding, partnership -> 5 pts ea (max 12) + diversity 2/type (max 8)

Prepared March 26, 2026

McChrystal Group

Leadership Advisory & Organizational Effectiveness

SECTION 1

Organization Snapshot

Legal Name	City of Seattle Police Department
Headquarters	610 5th Avenue, Seattle, WA 98104
Founded	1886
Ownership	Municipal government agency under the City of Seattle; overseen by Community Police Commission, Office of Inspector General, and Office of Police Accountability
Footprint	83.78 square miles across 5 precincts (North, East, South, Southwest, West), serving ~750,000 residents

SECTION 1b

Company Overview

The Seattle Police Department operates on a \$462 million annual budget and is rebuilding from a historic staffing crisis (913 deployable officers, lowest since 1990s). Under Chief Shon Barnes (confirmed July 2025), SPD is executing a major hiring surge (167 officers in 2025) while standing up the CARE Department civilian crisis response model and navigating a mayoral transition. SPD emerged from 13 years of federal consent decree oversight (terminated September 2025).

SECTION 2

Financial Health & Growth Stage

Understanding Seattle Police Department's financial position and trajectory is critical to framing any engagement conversation.

- Budget: \$457.9M (2025), \$462-486M (2026) - 15.7% increase from 2024
- Key investments: \$26M for 86 net new officers in 2026; \$10M one-time for overtime hot-spot patrols; \$36M CARE Department investment
- Overtime pressures: Budget grew from \$37M (2023) to \$54M (2024) due to staffing shortfalls
- Public sentiment: Politically contentious - Council debated police vs. social services; SPOG contract approved with 3 dissenting votes

SECTION 3

Leadership Team Profiles

The following contacts are recommended as primary outreach targets - champion-level leaders who feel the organizational pain daily and can sponsor McChrystal internally.

Yvonne Underwood - Deputy Chief, Patrol Operations/Investigations/Metro Safety/Special Ops [PRIORITY TARGET]

Oversees 4 major bureaus - operational nexus of SPD's transformation

Outreach rationale: Sits at the operational nexus of SPD transformation, overseeing both traditional policing and bureaus that must integrate with CARE. Natural champion for cross-functional alignment

Amy Barden - Chief, CARE Department [PRIORITY TARGET]

Leads civilian crisis response alternative - 5,000+ annual crisis responses that SPOG members have documented undermining

Outreach rationale: Represents civilian side of the transformation - experiencing organizational sabotage directly. Would champion integration work

Additional leadership team members relevant to the engagement:

Shon Barnes - Chief of Police

Ph.D. Leadership Studies NC A&T; M.S. Criminal Justice U. Cincinnati. Former Madison WI chief. DOJ subject matter expert on police leadership. No military background

Andre Sayles - Deputy Chief

External hire by Barnes - signals intent to bring new perspectives

Mike Fields - Executive Director of Human Resources

Reports directly to Chief; leads all HR initiatives during hiring surge and retention challenges

SECTION 4

Organizational Culture & Structure

Culture and structure are often where McChrystal Group finds the deepest leverage. The following signals indicate how Seattle Police Department operates today and where friction exists.

Organizational Structure

5 precincts, multiple specialized bureaus. Barnes decentralized authority to precinct captains - philosophically aligned with McChrystal's empowered execution model

Culture Signals

Post-consent decree identity crisis: 13 years of federal oversight (2012-2025) enforced behaviors without changing beliefs. Now must self-govern accountability.

Gender discrimination: 30x30 report documented pervasive sexual harassment and discrimination against women officers (only 14.4% women, declining). Former Chief Diaz named in harassment lawsuit.

Internal instability: Assistant chief demoted Jan 2025; another on medical leave 'due to chaos.' COO described department as 'increasingly unstable.'

SPOG resistance to CARE: Union rep told dispatchers CARE would be 'disbanded in 2025.' Officers actively wave off civilian responders. New SPOG contract limits CARE expansion.

Glassdoor: Mixed - good pay, supportive command staff under Barnes. 73% of exit interviews cited city leadership as reason for leaving. 'Morale and retention will never be achieved in the political climate of Seattle.'

SECTION 5

Recent News & Trigger Events

The following developments from the past 18 months create urgency and provide natural conversation entry points for engaging Seattle Police Department.

1. 2025-02-01 - Chief Shon Barnes starts as Seattle's new police chief

Fourth chief in three years - reform-oriented academic leader receptive to McChrystal's operating model

2. 2025-04-01 - SPD described as 'increasingly unstable' in internal communications

Documents the organizational dysfunction Barnes inherited - validates need for external transformation support

3. 2025-09-03 - Federal consent decree terminated after 13 years

Inflection point - SPD must sustain reforms without external enforcement. Needs internal operating model to replace external oversight

4. 2025-10-01 - Report documents officers systematically undermining CARE Department

Textbook case of organizational resistance - one part of the system actively sabotaging another. McChrystal's shared consciousness work designed for exactly this

5. 2025-10-15 - SPOG contract approved with CARE limitations; 3 Council members dissent

Contract formalizes tension between traditional policing and alternative response - requires leadership alignment and culture change

6. 2025-12-01 - Record hiring year: 167 officers hired, net +94, lowest attrition since 2016

Success creates new challenge - integrating 167 new officers into a department in cultural transition

SECTION 6

McChrystal Fit Assessment

Clear McChrystal fit (SPD-CARE integration is Team of Teams), clear champions (Barnes, Underwood, Barden). Moderated by: political sensitivity around policing consulting in Seattle, SPOG resistance, budget is adequate but spending politically fraught

Primary Problem

SPD must integrate two fundamentally different operating models - traditional armed police response and civilian CARE crisis response - while rebuilding culture scarred by 13 years of oversight, four chiefs in three years, gender discrimination, and active union resistance

Best McChrystal Capability Fit

Cross-functional alignment between SPD and CARE (breaking active sabotage); organizational culture change

post-consent decree; leadership development for Barnes's new team; Team of Teams connecting 5 precincts with civilian response

Likely Objections to Engagement

We just got out of federal oversight - we don't need another outside entity
Budget scrutiny on consulting spending
SPOG resistance to external influence
We've already turned the corner (2025 hiring/crime stats)

Competitive Advisory Landscape

University-based police reform advisors (Barnes's academic network)
DOJ technical assistance programs
21st Century Policing consultants
No sustained organizational transformation firm engaged [INFERRED]

SECTION 7

Conversation Entry Points

These questions are designed for a Senior Partner's first conversation. Each opens a thread that naturally leads to McChrystal Group's capabilities without a direct pitch.

1. You're overseeing four bureaus that all need to coordinate with CARE responders - but your officers are actively waving them off. How do you build shared consciousness between two systems that the union contract structurally separates?

For Deputy Chief Underwood - concrete operational problem

2. You've decentralized authority to precinct captains, which mirrors exactly how we think about empowered execution. But how do you maintain shared consciousness across 5 precincts when the consent decree framework that enforced consistency is gone?

For Chief Barnes - academic engagement with Team of Teams framework

3. SPD is trying to do something no major department has done: build a permanent civilian crisis response unit with direct dispatch authority alongside sworn officers. What's the operating model for making that work?

CARE integration as the concrete entry point

Recommended Meeting Framing

Position as 'the operating model for post-consent decree sustainability.' Frame around SPD-CARE integration - concrete, urgent, politically aligned with both progressive (CARE expansion) and moderate (effective policing) priorities.

SECTION 8

Brand Insights & Market Positioning

Brand strategy reveals organizational priorities and coordination challenges. The following analysis connects Seattle Police Department's market positioning to potential McChrystal engagement opportunities.

SPD's brand defined by 2020 CHOP/CHAZ incident and subsequent 'defund' era mass exodus (400+ officers lost 2020-2023). Under Barnes, repositioning from 'department under oversight' to 'department that chose reform.' 2025 crime reduction (18%) and hiring surge are proof points.

Brand tension: Needs to recruit aggressively (employer brand) while transforming culture (community brand). CARE represents brand evolution toward diversified public safety, but SPOG resistance means 'compassionate, modern policing' promise runs ahead of internal reality.

McChrystal connection: Brand gap mirrors organizational gap - promises modern, integrated policing but structurally operates as traditional department with civilian alternative bolted on.

SECTION 9

Deep McChrystal Group Fit Analysis

This is the strategic case for pursuing Seattle Police Department. It synthesizes findings from all previous sections into a comprehensive engagement thesis with specific fit dimensions, expected outcomes, stakeholder mapping, and a phased pursuit strategy.

9a. Fit Dimensions

Fit Dimension 1: SPD-CARE Integration - Officers actively undermining civilian responders. Not a policy problem - a trust and shared consciousness failure. McChrystal uniquely positioned: core Team of Teams challenge of two organizations that must operate as one.

Fit Dimension 2: Post-Consent Decree Operating Model - 13 years of external enforcement now gone. SPD needs internal mechanisms to sustain reform. McChrystal replaces external enforcement with internal shared consciousness.

Fit Dimension 3: New Leadership Team Formation - Almost entirely new command team (Underwood, Sayles, Powell, Fields). Must gel quickly under political pressure from new mayor while managing union resistance. McChrystal builds team operating models, not individual coaching.

Fit Dimension 4: Culture Transformation - 30x30 report (sexual harassment), exit interviews (73% cite city leadership), internal instability. Barnes's decentralization is the right instinct but needs a framework.

9b. Cumulative Case

Leadership instability (4 chiefs) -> New chief with reform mandate (Feb 2025) -> Consent decree termination (Sep 2025) -> CARE sabotage (Oct 2025) -> Record hiring requiring cultural onboarding -> New mayor (Jan 2026)

Revenue potential: Phase 1 (SPD-CARE pilot): \$350K-\$500K | Phase 2 (department-wide): \$600K-\$1M | Phase 3

(culture embedding): \$400K-\$750K | Total: \$1.35M-\$2.25M

9c. Enterprise Issues

1. Active internal sabotage of CARE integration
2. Post-consent decree sustainability gap
3. Serial leadership turnover trauma (4 chiefs in 3 years)
4. Gender discrimination and cultural toxicity (30x30 report)
5. Union resistance as structural obstacle
6. Precinct isolation and inconsistency
7. Mass onboarding culture challenge (167 new officers)

9d. Expected Outcomes

1. Integrated SPD-CARE dispatch model - acceptance rate to 85%+; behavioral health response time reduced 30%
2. Post-consent decree self-governance framework - quarterly self-assessment matching consent decree compliance
3. Command team alignment - shared framework in 6 months; decision cycle time reduced 30-50%
4. Precinct-to-precinct shared consciousness - monthly knowledge sharing; 60%+ best practice adoption
5. Culture transformation dashboard - 15-20% improvement in key metrics within 18 months
6. New officer integration program - 90%+ retention at 18 months; 75%+ CARE buy-in

9e. Key Stakeholders

Chief's Office

Leader: Shon Barnes

Function: Strategy, reform vision

Relevance: Executive sponsor

Patrol/Investigations

Leader: DC Yvonne Underwood

Function: Frontline operations

Relevance: PRIMARY TARGET

CARE Department

Leader: Amy Barden

Function: Civilian crisis response

Relevance: SECONDARY TARGET

Special Ops

Leader: AC Davis

Function: Specialized units

Relevance: High-risk coordination

Human Resources

Leader: Mike Fields

Function: Recruitment, onboarding

Relevance: Mass hiring integration

SPOG

Leader: Union leadership

Function: Labor agreements

Relevance: Navigate, don't fight

9f. Opportunity Thesis

Why Now: Consent decree exit (Sep 2025) -> documented CARE sabotage (Oct 2025) -> SPOG contract limiting integration -> record hiring requiring onboarding -> new mayor (Jan 2026). First time in 13 years SPD must self-govern.

Why McChrystal: University researchers write policy papers; DOJ programs provide technical assistance; McKinsey/Deloitte would be politically toxic in Seattle's policing context. McChrystal is differentiated by not being traditional consultancy, having proven cross-functional integration model, and being able to speak credibly to both police and civilians.

Phased Engagement: Phase 1 (4-6 months, \$350K-\$500K): SPD-CARE integration pilot in 1-2 precincts | Phase 2 (12 months, \$600K-\$1M): Department-wide operating model | Phase 3 (12 months, \$400K-\$750K): Culture embedding + scaling

Pursuit Map: Thread 1: DC Underwood via CARE integration. Thread 2: CARE Chief Barden (civilian side). Thread 3: Chief Barnes via academic/policing conferences.